

City/County Monthly Update: September 22, 2026

11:00 a.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Additional Attendees: Cliff Scherf, Mayor; Aaron Cubic, City Manager; and Rick Riker, Council Member

Chair Ron Smith called the joint meeting to order at 11:00 a.m.

1. Public Lands

The City and County discussed reviewing publicly owned properties located within each other's jurisdictions to identify possible future property exchanges or joint-use opportunities. Discussion focused on whether existing downtown parking areas could support a multi-level parking structure as a joint City-County project. Potential locations, including the Growers Market/Grasshopper area and County-owned parking near the courthouse and library, were discussed. The City agreed to bring back its most recent downtown parking study, including historical and projected parking demand, so the conversation can continue. No decisions were made.

2. Car Camping in UGB or on County Property

The City discussed the continuing issue of people living in vehicles and whether a managed overnight vehicle-camping area could be developed as a joint City-County effort. The discussion included the City's existing camping regulations, HB 3115, potential locations near the city limits, law-enforcement access, liability, insurance, sanitation, security and the possible use of a nonprofit operator under a lease. Participants discussed examples from other communities and emphasized that no specific site or operating model has been selected. The matter will remain on the agenda for further discussion.

No decisions were made.

3. Youth Community Center

Mayor Scherf raised the idea of creating a youth community center and asked whether a fairgrounds building might be considered for year-round use. The group discussed the need for youth recreational and community space, existing and planned services through organizations such as the Boys & Girls Club and YMCA, the seasonal use of fairgrounds buildings, possible alternate locations, and the long-term operating subsidy that a community center could require. Participants agreed the concept warrants additional community input and future discussion, but no location or funding plan was selected.

No decisions were made.

4. Other/Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners - ORS 192.640(1)

The City and County discussed additional collaboration on housing and development. Topics included bringing developers, builders and realtors together with City and County planning/building staff; the City's development task force; workforce housing; Middle-Income Revolving Loan (MIRL/MERL) funding described by the City; and comparing permit-processing practices and timelines. The parties agreed to encourage coordination between their planning/building departments. Commissioner Richardson also expressed concern about limited City engagement on prior long-range planning for North Valley sewer and water extensions; City representatives agreed to work on improving communication. The group agreed to revisit public lands, car camping and the youth community center at the next monthly meeting, along with an update on planning/building collaboration. No formal decisions were made.

The meeting adjourned at 12:07 p.m.